



POINT SELECTION: LUO CONNECTING & YUAN SOURCE

PERMISSION TO USE AND ADOPT FROM SLIDES
CREATED BY RYAN LILLY, LAC

FUNCTIONS OF YUAN SOURCE POINTS

- Source point is related to the respective organ, channel, and original Qi
- Each of the 12 meridians has a yuan source point
 - But what is Yuan Source Qi:
 - Originates below the umbilicus and between the two kidneys, is dispersed to the Zang Fu organs and further to the limbs via the San Jiao (CAM). It is life giving and the root of the 12 channels. The san jiao causes the original yuan qi to differentiate for its different uses around the body (to the organs and meridians)

**WHAT ARE THE FUNCTIONS OF THE
YUAN SOURCE POINTS?**

**WHAT TRANSPORT/ELEMENT POINTS
DO THEY OVERLAP WITH?**

FUNCTIONS OF YUAN SOURCE POINTS

- **Yin** Yuan Source points tonify Yin Organs
 - Overlap with Shu stream Points – 3rd point from the distal end of the channel
- **Yang** Yuan Source points reduce excess pathogenic factors in Yang Organs
 - Except SJ 4, also relates to the original Qi
 - Follows the Shu stream point – 4th point from the distal end of the channel (Except GB which is the 5th point.
- **It is common to see differences within the same point category between zang (yin) and fu (yang) points.**
 - **Why do you think we see this difference?**

12 YUAN SOURCE POINTS

Zang/Yin Organs:

Liver: LV3

Heart: HT7

Spleen: SP3

Lung: LU9

Kidney: KD3

Pericardium: P7

Fu/Yang Organs:

Gallbladder: GB40

Small Intestine: SI4

Stomach: ST42

Large Intestine: LI4

Urinary Bladder: UB64

San Jiao: SJ4

FUNCTIONS OF LUO CONNECTING POINTS

Deadman:

1. Treating disorders of interiorly-exteriorly related channel or Zang Fu
 - Can use yuan source and luo connecting point pairs (**Guest-Host**)
2. Departs from the main channel from the Luo connecting point and travels along its own trajectory
 - Treats disorders in regions reached by the Luo Connecting Channel
 - Increases area of influence of the main channel
3. Treating psycho-emotional disorders

Maciocia:

1. In conjunction with Source point of the primarily affected channel
2. According to their specific action regardless of their classification
 - Can either be FULL or EMPTY, just like the main channel (Ling Shu chapter 10)

15 LUO CONNECTING POINTS

Zang/Yin Organs:

Liver: LV5
Heart: HT5
Spleen: SP4
Lung: LU7
Kidney: KD4
Pericardium: P6

Fu/Yang Organs:

Gallbladder: GB37
Small Intestine: SI7
Stomach: ST40
Large Intestine: LI6
Urinary Bladder: UB58
San Jiao: SJ5

Additional Luo:

Du: DU1
Ren: Ren 15
Great Luo: SP21



LUO CONNECTING CHANNELS

- The connecting channels are called luo mai: luo implies the meaning of “network”
- The Main Channels are called Jing Mai and jing implies the meaning of “line, route or way” (Maciocia)

LOCATION OF LUO CONNECTING CHANNELS

- Three separate entities
 - Luo Connecting Channels themselves
 - Qi and Ying Level
 - Space more superficial than the Luo connecting channels (all the way to the skin)
 - Minute/superficial collaterals (Sun Luo/Fu Luo)
 - Wei Level – protecting and warming
 - Between primary channels and the internal organs
 - Connect to blood vessels and Xue (Blood) level
 - Nourishing
- Luo connecting channels are prone to Qi and Blood stagnation

DEPTH OF LUO CONN. CHANNELS

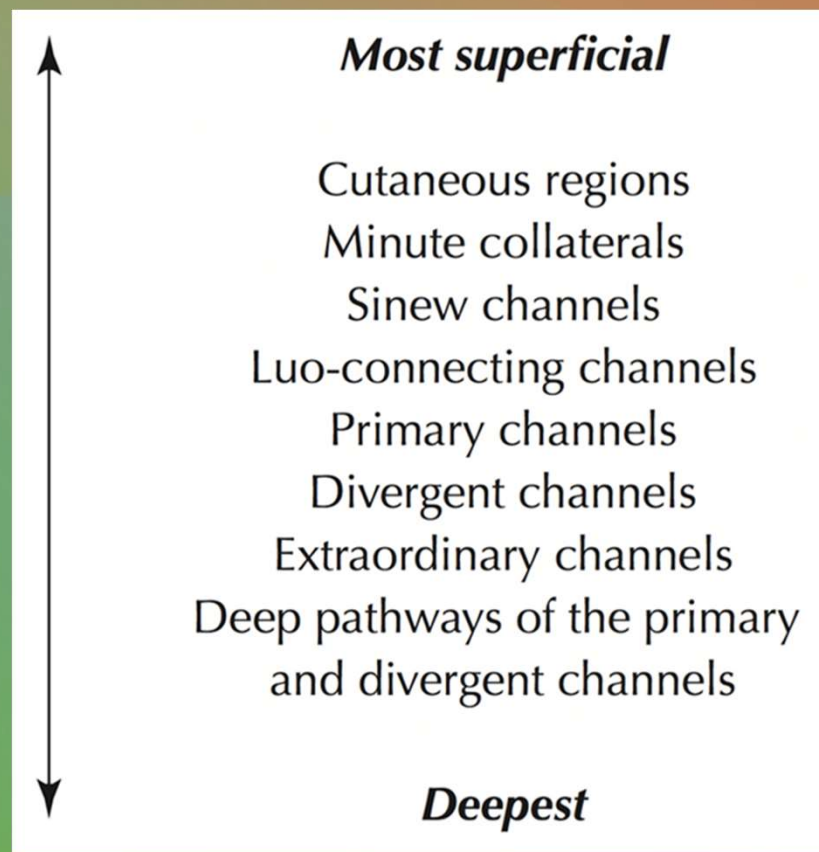


Figure 51.4 Connecting and main channels areas

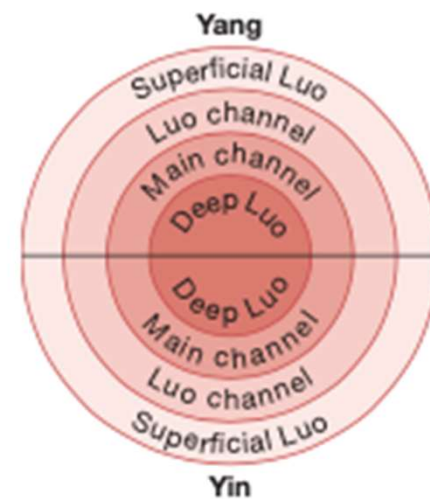


Figure 51.5 Connecting and main channels areas in section

GUEST-HOST COMBO: YUAN SOURCE + LUO CONNECTING

- When tonifying a specific channel or organ using the source point, the Luo connecting point of the interiorly-exteriorly associated channel may be used to strengthen the treatment. (Deadman)
 - Enforce the Yuan Source Point of the affected channel or organ due to its interior/exterior or Yin/Yang relationship.
- Also called the Guest-Host method
 - Host = Yuan Source, where the pathology lies
 - Guest = the interior/exterior paired channel

GUEST-HOST COMBO CONT

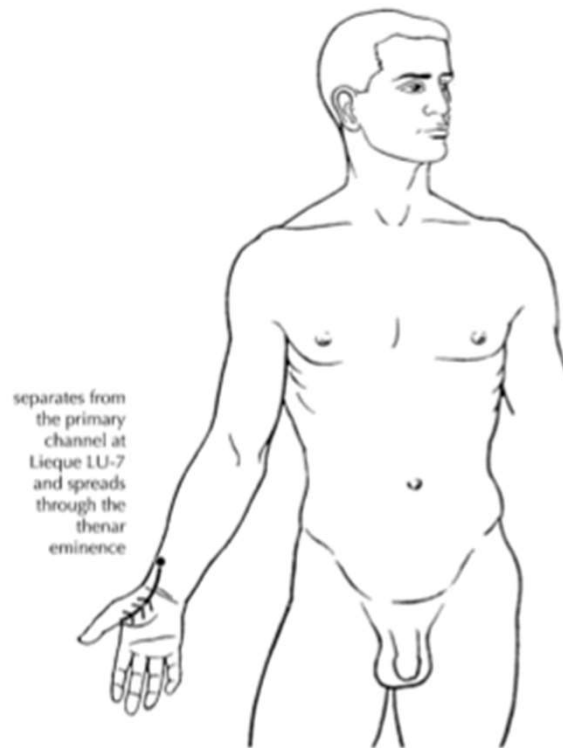
- CAM suggests a slightly different use of Guest Host
 - When a disease occurs in both an interior and exterior channel (ex: lung and Large Intestine) needle the yuan source of the channel that was first affected and the luo connecting point of the channel that was affected second
 - Ex: LU9 + LI6 or LI4 + LU7
- The symptoms of each Luo Connecting channel often include ones from its respective interiorly/exteriorly related channel.

LUNG LUO CONNECTING CHANNEL PATHOLOGY AND POINT INDICATIONS

Cheng, Xinnong, ed. Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion. 3rd ed. Seventeenth Printing 2016. Beijing: Foreign Languages Press, 2009. Page 139

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The Lung luo-connecting channel

THE LUNG LUO-CONNECTING CHANNEL

- separates from the Lung primary channel at Lieque LU-7,
- follows the Lung channel into the palm and spreads through the thenar eminence,
- connects with the Lung channel's interiorly-exteriorly related Large Intestine channel.

- FULL: hot palms and wrists
- EMPTY: yawning, frequent urination, incontinence of urine

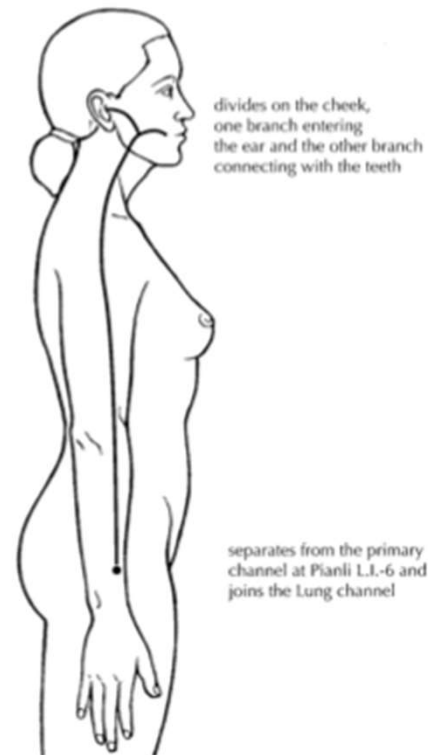
Indications of LU 7 (CAM)

- Headache, Migraine, Neck rigidity
- Cough
- Asthma
- Sore throat
- Facial Paralysis
- Toothache
- Pain and weakness of wrist

LARGE INTESTINE LUO CONNECTING CHANNEL PATHOLOGY AND POINT INDICATIONS

THE LARGE INTESTINE LUO-CONNECTING CHANNEL

- begins at Pianli L.I.-6,
- joins with its interiorly-exteriorly associated Lung channel three cun above the wrist,
- ascends the arm through Jianyu L.I.-15 to the jaw and cheek, where it divides, one branch connecting with the teeth, the other entering the ear to join the 'zong mai' (where the channels of the Large Intestine, Stomach, Small Intestine, Gall Bladder and Sanjiao gather and collect at the ear).



The Large Intestine luo-connecting channel

- FULL: toothache, deafness
- EMPTY: sensation of cold in teeth, fullness and congestion in the chest

Indications of LI 6 (CAM)

- Redness of eye
- Tinnitus
- Deafness
- Epistaxis
- Aching of hand and arm
- Sore throat
- Edema

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YUAN SOURCE + LUO CONNECTING COMBO

Yuan Source	Luo Connecting
LU 9	LI 6
LI 4	LU 7
ST 42	SP 4
SP 3	ST 40
HT 7	SI 7
SI 4	HT 5
UB 64	KID 4
KID 3	UB 58
PC 7	SJ 5
SJ 4	PC 6
GB 40	LIV 5
LIV 3	GB 37

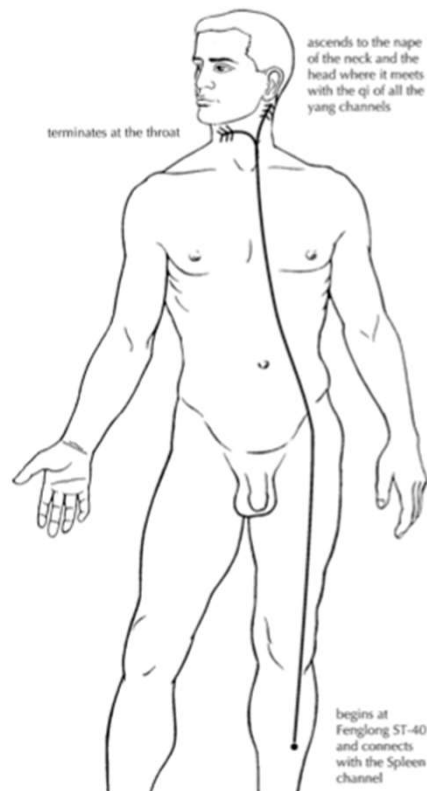
- Héǒ L.I.-4 and Lièquē LU-7:
 - Toothache, swollen gums, yellow eyes, dry mouth, runny nose, epistaxis, swollen throat, shoulder pain
 - exterior pathogenic wind invades the exterior of the body. To restore descending function of the Lung qì.
- Tàiyuān LU-9 and Piānlì L.I.-6
 - Stifling sensation of the chest, hot palms, swollen throat, dry throat, sweating, shoulder pain, pain in the breasts, expectoration of phlegm, breathlessness.

STOMACH LUO CONNECTING CHANNEL PATHOLOGY AND POINT INDICATIONS

Cheng, Xinnong, ed. Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion. 3rd ed. Seventeenth Printing 2016. Beijing: Foreign Languages Press, 2009. Page 154

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THE STOMACH LUO-CONNECTING CHANNEL

- originates on the lateral side of the lower leg at Fenglong ST-40,
- travels to the medial aspect of the lower leg to join with the Spleen channel,
- ascends the leg and trunk to the nape of the neck and head where it converges with the qi of the other yang channels,
- then travels internally to terminate at the throat.

- FULL: insanity (kuáng), rebellious, throat obstruction, loss of voice
- EMPTY: flaccid or atrophied muscles of legs

Indications of ST 40 (CAM)

- Headache
- Dizziness / vertigo
- Cough
- Asthma
- Excess sputum
- Pain in the chest
- Constipation
- Mania
- Epilepsy
- Muscular atrophy/motor impairment/pain, swelling or paralysis of the lower extremity

SPLEEN LUO CONNECTING CHANNEL PATHOLOGY AND POINT INDICATIONS

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The luo-connecting channel of the Spleen

THE SPLEEN LUO-CONNECTING CHANNEL

- originates at Gongsun SP-4,
- connects with the Stomach channel,
- enters the abdomen and connects with the intestines and Stomach.

- FULL: abdominal pain, rebellious Qi, food poisoning (Huò Luàn/Cholera)
- EMPTY: abdominal distention

Indications of SP4 (CAM)

- Gastric Pain
- Vomiting
- Abdominal Pain and Distention
- Diarrhea
- Dysentery
- Borborygmus

YUAN SOURCE + LUO CONNECTING COMBO

Yuan Source	Luo Connecting
LU 9	LI 6
LI 4	LU 7
ST 42	SP 4
SP 3	ST 40
HT 7	SI 7
SI 4	HT 5
UB 64	KID 4
KID 3	UB 58
PC 7	SJ 5
SJ 4	PC 6
GB 40	LIV 5
LIV 3	GB 37

Tàibái SP-3 and Fēnglóng ST-40: deficiency of the Spleen is the root cause of the formation of excessive phlegm.

- Tàibái SP-3 is an important point to tonify the Spleen,
- Fēnglóng ST-40 is the primary point on the body to resolve phlegm.

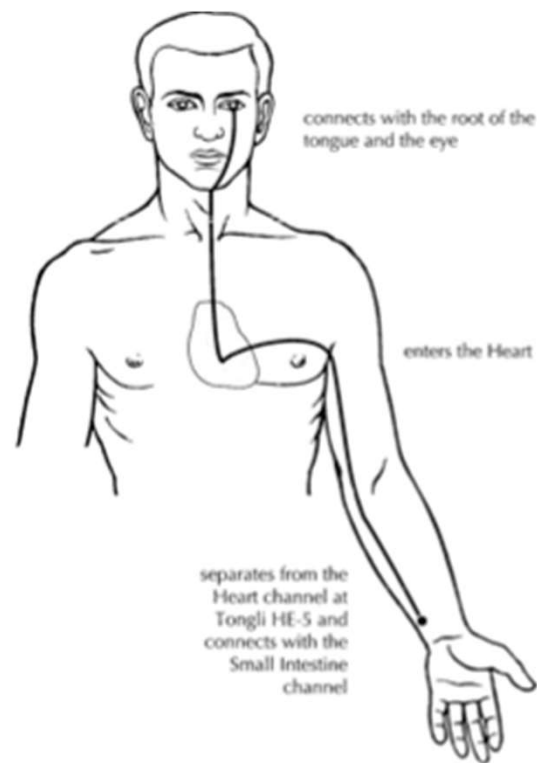
Chōngyáng ST-42 and Gōngsūn SP-4: abdominal distention, fullness, stifling sensation at the chest, epistaxis, phlegm, foot pain and ankle pain.

HEART LUO CONNECTING CHANNEL PATHOLOGY AND POINT INDICATIONS

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THE HEART LUO-CONNECTING CHANNEL

- separates from the Heart channel at Tongli HE-5 and connects with the Small Intestine channel,
- follows the Heart channel to the Heart zang then continues to the root of the tongue and the eye.

- FULL: fullness and oppression of chest
- EMPTY: aphasia

Indications of HT5 (CAM)

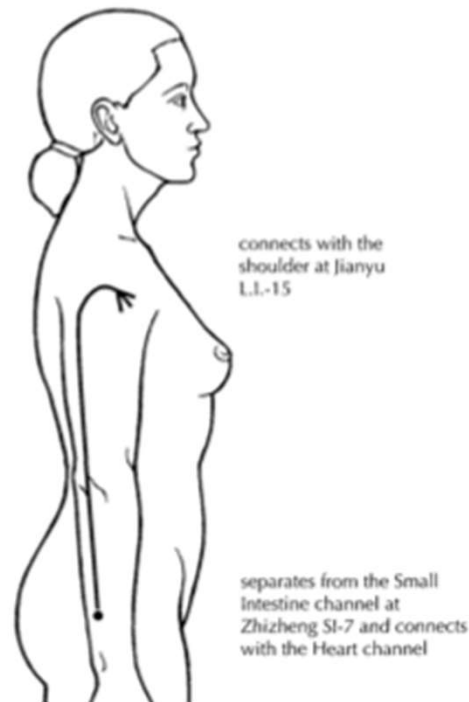
- Palpitation
- Dizziness
- Blurry Vision
- Sore throat
- Sudden loss of voice
- Aphasia with stiffness of tongue
- Pain in the wrist and elbow

SMALL INTESTINE LUO CONNECTING CHANNEL PATHOLOGY AND POINT INDICATIONS

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THE SMALL INTESTINE LUO-CONNECTING CHANNEL

- separates from the Small Intestine channel at Zhizheng SI-7 and connects with the Heart channel,
- ascends along the arm and connects with the shoulder at Jianyu L.I.-15.

- FULL: loose joints, atrophy of arm muscles, stiff elbow
- EMPTY: long, finger shaped warts, itching scabs

Indications of SI 7 (CAM)

- Neck rigidity
- Headache
- Dizziness
- Spasmodic pain in the elbow and fingers
- Febrile diseases
- Mania

YUAN SOURCE + LUO CONNECTING COMBO

Yuan Source	Luo Connecting
LU 9	LI 6
LI 4	LU 7
ST 42	SP 4
SP 3	ST 40
HT 7	SI 7
SI 4	HT 5
UB 64	KID 4
KID 3	UB 58
PC 7	SJ 5
SJ 4	PC 6
GB 40	LIV 5
LIV 3	GB 37

Shénmén HE-7 and Zhīzhèng SI-7:

- Heart pain, dry throat, yellow eyes, dry mouth, hot palms, palpitation, vomiting of blood, fright

Wǎngǔ SI-4 Tōnglǐ HT-5:

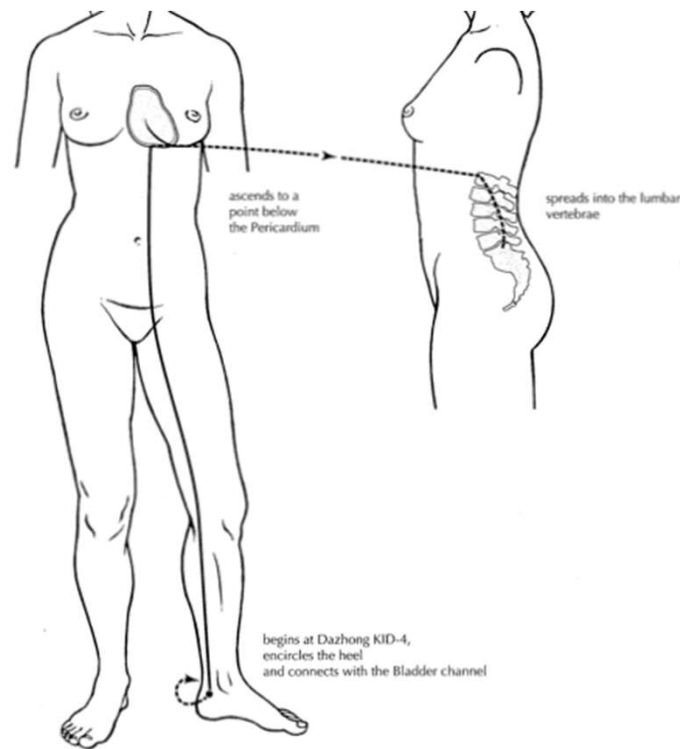
- Stiff neck, swelling and pain in throat, shoulder pain, deafness, yellow eyes, pain on lateral aspect of upper arms

KIDNEY LUO CONNECTING CHANNEL PATHOLOGY AND POINT INDICATIONS

Cheng, Xinnong, ed. Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion. 3rd ed. Seventeenth Printing 2016. Beijing: Foreign Languages Press, 2009. Page 187

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THE KIDNEY LUO-CONNECTING CHANNEL

- begins at Dazhong KID-4 on the posterior aspect of the medial malleolus,
- encircles the heel and enters internally to connect with the Bladder channel,
- ascends along with the Kidney primary channel from Dazhong KID-4 to a point below the Pericardium where it travels posteriorly to and spreads into the lumbar vertebrae.

- FULL: retention of urine, rebellious, irritability, depression, oppression of chest
- EMPTY: lower back pain

Indications of KID 4 (CAM)

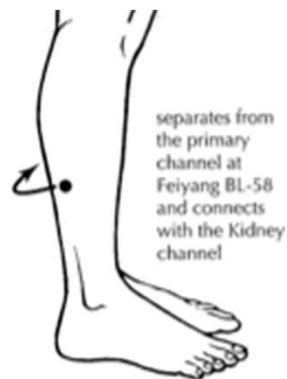
- Spitting of blood
- Asthma
- Stiffness and pain of the lower back
- Dysuria
- Constipation
- Pain in the heel
- Dementia

BLADDER LUO CONNECTING CHANNEL PATHOLOGY AND POINT INDICATIONS

Cheng, Xinnong, ed. Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion. 3rd ed. Seventeenth Printing 2016. Beijing: Foreign Languages Press, 2009. Page 184

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The Bladder luo-connecting channel

THE BLADDER LUO-CONNECTING CHANNEL

- separates from the primary channel at Feiyang BL-58 and connects with the Kidney channel.

- FULL: Nasal congestion, headache, backache
- EMPTY: clear nasal discharge, nosebleed

Indications of UB 58 (CAM)

- Headache
- Blurry vision
- Nasal obstruction
- Epistaxis
- Back pain
- Hemorrhoids
- Weakness of the leg

YUAN SOURCE + LUO CONNECTING COMBO

Yuan Source	Luo Connecting
LU 9	LI 6
LI 4	LU 7
ST 42	SP 4
SP 3	ST 40
HT 7	SI 7
SI 4	HT 5
UB 64	KID 4
KID 3	UB 58
PC 7	SJ 5
SJ 4	PC 6
GB 40	LIV 5
LIV 3	GB 37

Tàixī KID-3 and Fēiyáng BL-58:

- Dark complexion, no thirst, desire to lie down, decreased vision, feeling of heat, backache, weakness of lower limbs, shortness of breath.

Jīnggǔ UB 64, Dàzhōng K4:

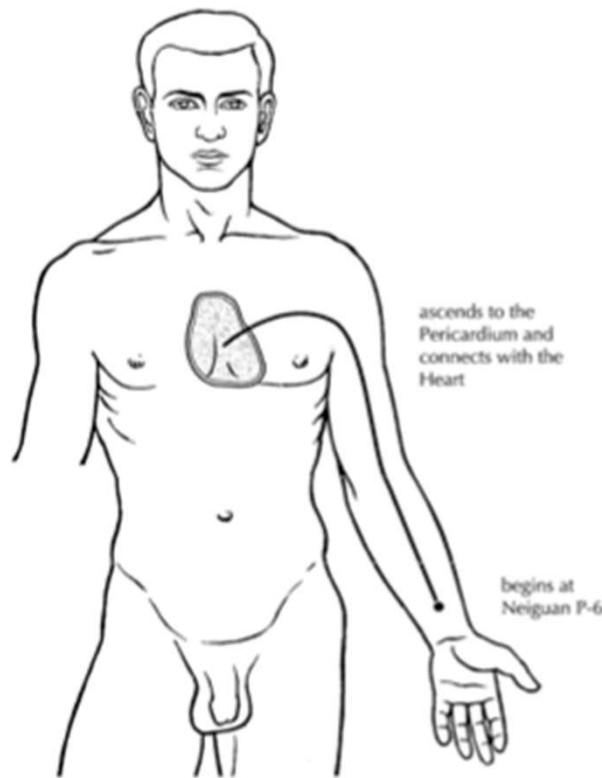
- Eye pain, neckache, pain from neck to back to lower limbs, mania, epilepsy, opisthotonos, eyebrow region pain, epistaxis, yellow eyes, contraction of tendons, prolapse ani

PERICARDIUM LUO CONNECTING CHANNEL PATHOLOGY AND POINT INDICATIONS

Cheng, Xinnong, ed. Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion. 3rd ed. Seventeenth Printing 2016. Beijing: Foreign Languages Press, 2009. Page 196

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THE PERICARDIUM LUO-CONNECTING CHANNEL

- begins at Neiguan P-6 on the anterior of the forearm,
- ascends along with the Pericardium primary channel to the Pericardium and then connects with the Heart.

- FULL: chest pain
- EMPTY: stiffness of the head and neck

Indications of PC 6 (CAM)

- Cardiac pain
- Palpitation
- Stuffy chest
- Hypochondriac pain
- Stomachache
- Nausea/vomiting, Hiccup
- Epilepsy
- Insomnia
- Febrile diseases
- Irritability
- Malaria
- Contracture and pain of elbow and arm

SAN JIAO LUO CONNECTING CHANNEL PATHOLOGY AND POINT INDICATIONS

Cheng, Xinnong, ed. Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion. 3rd ed. Seventeenth Printing 2016. Beijing: Foreign Languages Press, 2009. Page 198

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THE SANJIAO LUO-CONNECTING CHANNEL

- separates from the Sanjiao primary channel at Waiguan SJ-5,
- proceeds up the posterior aspect of the arm and over the shoulder, converging with the Pericardium channel in the chest.

- FULL: spasm of elbow
- EMPTY: flaccid arm muscles

Indications of SJ 5 (CAM)

- Febrile diseases
- Headache
- Pain in the cheek
- Strained neck
- Deafness
- Tinnitus
- Hypochondriac pain
- Motor impairment of elbow and arm
- Pain in the fingers
- Hand tremors

YUAN SOURCE + LUO CONNECTING COMBO

Yuan Source	Luo Connecting
LU 9	LI 6
LI 4	LU 7
ST 42	SP 4
SP 3	ST 40
HT 7	SI 7
SI 4	HT 5
UB 64	KID 4
KID 3	UB 58
PC 7	SJ 5
SJ 4	PC 6
GB 40	LIV 5
LIV 3	GB 37

Yángchí SJ-4 and Nèiguān p-6:

- tinnitus, deafness, swollen throat, dry throat, swollen eyes, earache, sweating, pain between scapulae, elbow pain, constipation, urinary incontinence, urinary retention.
- regulate the San Jiao, move Liver Qi, calm Shen.

Dàlíng PC 7 and Wàiguān PC7

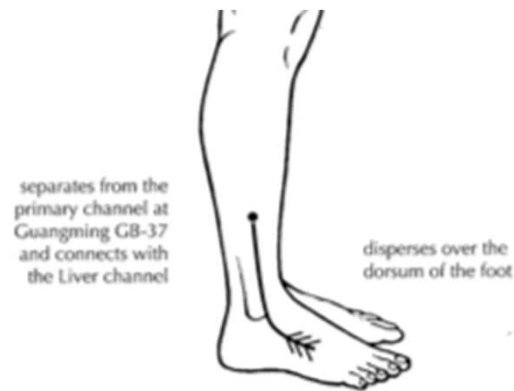
- Contracture of palms, arm pain, inability to extend arm, fullness of chest, swelling of axilla, palpitations red face, yellow eyes, laughing and crying without reason, mental restlessness, heart pain, hot palms

GALLBLADDER LUO CONNECTING CHANNEL PATHOLOGY AND POINT INDICATIONS

Cheng, Xinnong, ed. Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion. 3rd ed. Seventeenth Printing 2016. Beijing: Foreign Languages Press, 2009. Page 212

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The Gall Bladder luo-connecting channel

THE GALL BLADDER LUO-CONNECTING CHANNEL

- separates from the primary channel at Guangming GB-37,
- connects with the Liver channel,
- descends and disperses over the dorsum of the foot.

- FULL: fainting
- EMPTY: weak and flaccid foot muscles, difficult to stand from sitting position

Indications of GB 37 (CAM)

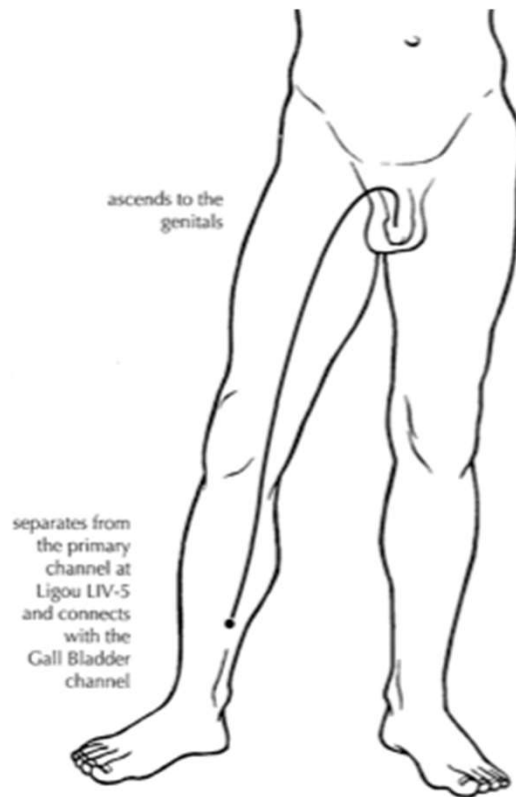
- Pain in the knee
- Muscular atrophy
- Motor impairment and pain in the lower extremities
- Blurry vision
- Ophthalmalgia
- Night blindness
- Distending pain of the breast

LIVER LUO CONNECTING CHANNEL PATHOLOGY AND POINT INDICATIONS

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THE LIVER LUO-CONNECTING CHANNEL

- separates from the primary channel at Ligou LIV-5 on the medial aspect of the lower leg,
- connects with the Gall Bladder channel,
- ascends to the genitals.

- FULL: swelling of testicle, hernia-like disorders (Shan), rebellious/abnormal erection
- EMPTY: itching of pubic region

Indications of LIV 5 (CAM)

- Retention of urine
- Enuresis
- Hernia
- Irregular menses
- Leukorrhea
- Vulvar pruritis
- Weakness and atrophy of the leg

YUAN SOURCE + LUO CONNECTING COMBO

Yuan Source	Luo Connecting
LU 9	LI 6
LI 4	LU 7
ST 42	SP 4
SP 3	ST 40
HT 7	SI 7
SI 4	HT 5
UB 64	KID 4
KID 3	UB 58
PC 7	SJ 5
SJ 4	PC 6
GB 40	LIV 5
LIV 3	GB 37

Tàichōng LIV-3 and Guāngmíng GB-37:

- Abdominal distension and hypogastric swelling in women, chest fullness, vomiting, hernia, urinary retention or incontinence
- Brighten the eyes in liver patterns

Qiūxū GB-40 and Lígōu LIV-5

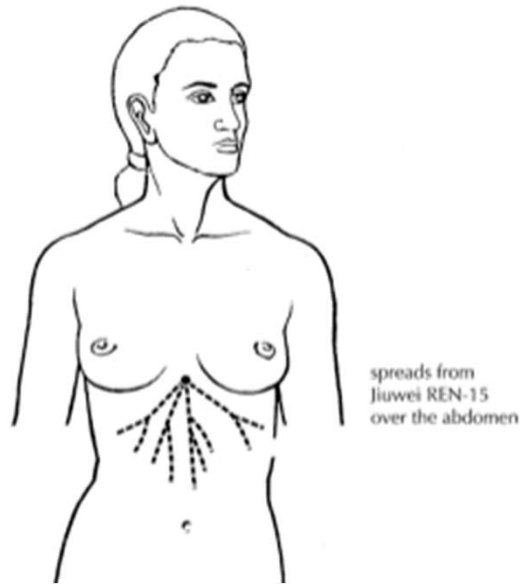
- dull complexion, headache, eye pain, swelling of neck, goiter, hypochondrial pain, swelling and sweating of axilla

REN LUO CONNECTING CHANNEL PATHOLOGY AND POINT INDICATIONS

Cheng, Xinnong, ed. Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion. 3rd ed. Seventeenth Printing 2016. Beijing: Foreign Languages Press, 2009. Page 250

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spreads from
Jiuwei REN-15
over the abdomen

THE CONCEPTION LUO-CONNECTING VESSEL

- descends from Jiuwei REN-15 and disperses over the abdomen.

- FULL: Pain in the skin of abdomen
- EMPTY: Itching of the skin of abdomen

Indications of REN 15 (CAM)

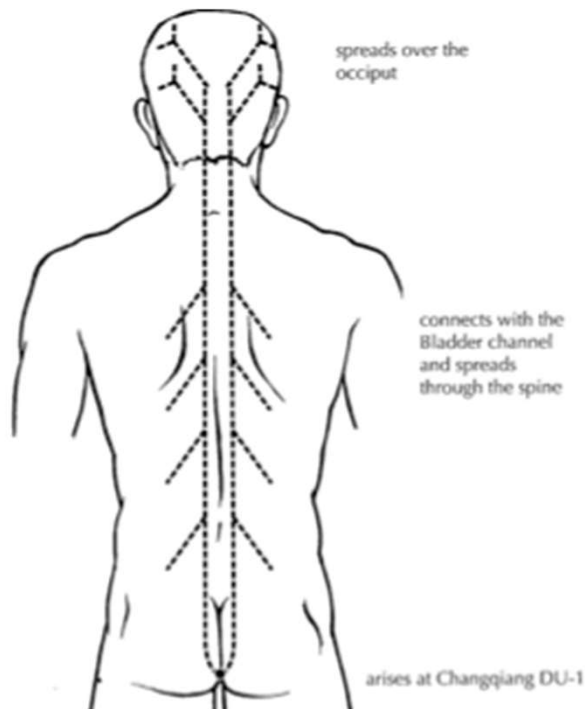
- Pain in the cardiac region and the chest
- Nausea
- Mental Disorders
- Epilepsy

DU LUO CONNECTING CHANNEL PATHOLOGY AND POINT INDICATIONS

Cheng, Xinnong, ed. Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion. 3rd ed. Seventeenth Printing 2016. Beijing: Foreign Languages Press, 2009. Page 221

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THE GOVERNING LUO-CONNECTING VESSEL

- arises at Changqiang DU-1 and ascends bilaterally along the sides of the spine to the nape of the neck and spreads over the occiput.
- at the scapular region it connects with the Bladder channel and threads through the spine.

- FULL: stiffness of spine
- EMPTY: heaviness of the head, tremor of the head

Indications of DU 1 (CAM)

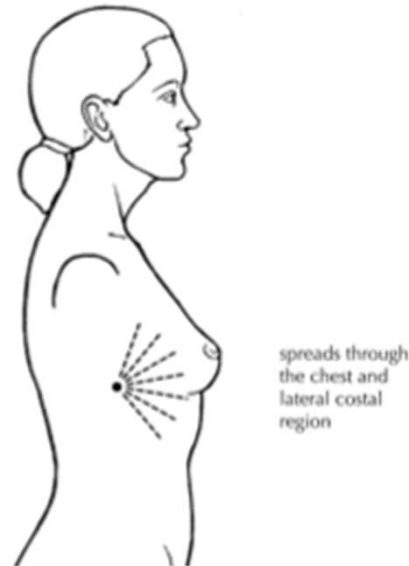
- Diarrhea
- Bloody stools
- Hemorrhoids
- Prolapse of rectum
- Constipation
- Lower back pain
- Epilepsy

THE GREAT LUO CONNECTING OF SPLEEN CHANNEL PATHOLOGY AND POINT INDICATIONS

Cheng, Xinnong, ed. Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion. 3rd ed. Seventeenth Printing 2016. Beijing: Foreign Languages Press, 2009. Page 160

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THE GREAT LUO-CONNECTING CHANNEL OF THE SPLEEN

- separates from the primary channel at Dabao SP-21 on the lateral aspect of the chest,
- spreads through the chest and lateral costal region, gathering the blood of the luo-connecting channels of the whole body.

- FULL: ache and pain all over body
- EMPTY: weak limb muscles

Indications of SP 21 (CAM)

- Pain in the chest and hypochondria
- Asthma
- General aching and weakness

EXERCISE

- Your task is to figure out which Source Point + Luo Connecting Point Combo is often used to treat these.
- Remember, source point is related to the respective organ, channel, and original Qi
 - Yin Yuan Source points tonify Yin Organs
 - Yang Yuan Source points reduce excess pathogenic factors in Yang Organs
 - Except SJ 4, also relates to the original Qi

1. Source: ____, Luo Connecting: ____

- Dark complexion
- Absence of thirst
- A desire to lie down
- Decreased vision
- A feeling of heat
- Backache
- Weak lower limbs
- Shortness of breath
- Timidity

Function:

Benefit kidney yin and and lower the excess Yang that is not rooted by the deficient Yin causing a rush of heat up toward the head

2. Source: ____, Luo Connecting: ____

- Stiff tongue
- Acid reflux
- Vomiting
- Abdominal distention
- Feeling of heaviness
- Constipation
- Weakness
- Swelling of Lower limbs

Function:

Tonify the spleen to resolve phlegm accumulation

3. Source: ____, Luo Connecting: ____

- Oppression of the chest
- Hot Palms
- Cough
- Throat swelling
- Dry throat
- Absence of Sweating
- Shoulder Pain
- Pain in the breasts
- Expectoration of Phlegm
- Breathlessness

Function:

Open and regulate water passages; especially when pathogenic wind results in the acute edema in the upper part of the body; may also have absent of sweat and difficult urination.

4. Source: ____, Luo Connecting: ____

- Tooth ache
- Swollen Gums
- Yellow eyes
- Dry mouth
- Runny nose
- Epistaxis
- Swollen Throat
- Shoulder Pain

Function:

Expel pathogenic wind from the exterior of the body and restore the distending functions of the lung.

5. Source: ____, Luo Connecting: ____

- Abdominal distention and hypogastric swelling in women
- Chest fullness
- Vomiting
- Hernia
- Urinary retention and incontinence

Function:

Eye disorders due to deficiency of liver blood, liver yin, or blazing of liver fire or liver Yang; regulate disharmonies and brightens the eyes

6. Source: ____, Luo Connecting: ____

- Pain in the heart
- Dry throat
- Thirst
- Yellow eyes
- Dry mouth
- Hot palms
- Palpitations
- Vomiting of blood
- Fright

Function:

Regulate heart and calm spirit to treat psycho-emotional disorders (mania, depression, fear/fright, sadness, anxiety, restless Zang)